

TOTALITY

The Exercise Library

Every exercise, broken down. Muscles worked, how to do it, coaching cues, the common mistake and who it suits, with the movement drawn step by step.



THE COMPLETE GUIDE

371 exercises, drawn step by step

34 chapters across legs, upper body, core and full body



Before you start

This guide is general education about exercise technique. It is not medical advice and it does not replace a conversation with a doctor, physiotherapist or qualified trainer.

TALK TO A PROFESSIONAL FIRST IF

- You have an injury, pain, or a medical condition, including heart or blood pressure conditions.
- You are pregnant or have recently had a baby.
- You have not trained for a long time and are not sure where to start.

TRAIN SAFELY

- Warm up first. A few minutes of easy movement and a couple of light sets of the exercise you are about to do is enough.
- Start lighter than you think you need to. Learn the movement before you chase weight.
- Use a rack with safety bars, or a spotter, for any heavy barbell lift where you could get stuck.
- Stop if you feel sharp pain. Discomfort from effort is normal. Pain is a signal to stop and get advice.

ABOUT THE ILLUSTRATIONS

Every exercise is drawn by the Totality stickman, so you can see the whole movement in four frames. The drawings show a typical, well-controlled repetition. Real bodies differ, so your range, stance and depth may look a little different, and that is fine.

ABOUT THE CONTENT

The exercise list, muscle groups, equipment, difficulty and rep ranges come from the Totality exercise library. Everything else, including the step by step instructions, common mistakes and progressions, was written for this guide.

What is inside

371 exercises in 34 chapters, in three volumes. Page numbers restart in each chapter, so the index at the back lists every exercise by chapter and exercise number.

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THE THREE VOLUMES

- Volume 1** Lower Body. Chapters 1 to 9.
- Volume 2** Upper Body. Chapters 10 to 23.
- Volume 3** Core, Full Body and Extras. Chapters 24 to 34, plus the exercise index.

How to use this guide

You do not need to read this book from front to back. Use it as a reference. Find the body part you want to train, pick an exercise that suits your level and equipment, and follow the page.

HOW THE BOOK IS ORGANISED

The guide is split into parts: lower body, upper body, core, and full body and power. Each part holds chapters, and each chapter holds a group of similar exercises, such as squats, hinges, presses or rows, ordered from easier to harder. If you are new to a pattern, start at the beginning of the chapter and work down.

EVERY EXERCISE GETS TWO PAGES

Page one: understand it

- The muscles it works
- Step by step instructions
- Coaching cues
- The most common mistake, and the fix
- Who it suits and why it works

Page two: see it

- Four drawn frames of the movement
- An easier option and a harder option
- Sets and reps for your goal

CHOOSING THE RIGHT EXERCISE

Pick by level first. Beginner exercises use a simple setup and a lighter load. Intermediate exercises assume you already move well in the basic version. Advanced exercises ask for strength, balance or mobility that takes time to build.

Then pick by equipment. Every exercise lists what you need, from no equipment at all to a barbell and rack, so you can choose a version that fits your home, gym or travel setup.

FINDING AN EXERCISE FAST

Use the contents to find the chapter, or the A to Z index at the back of Volume 3 to look up an exercise by name. The index gives the chapter and the exercise number.

A SIMPLE WAY TO PROGRESS

Learn the movement with an easy version. Add reps and control. Then add load a little at a time. When the technique starts to slip, you have gone up too fast. Drop back a step, tidy it up, and move on again.

How to read an exercise page

MUSCLE COLOURS

On each page, the figure shows which muscles are doing the work. The muscle turns from black to red.

- **Red** is a primary muscle. It does most of the work.
- **Light red** is a secondary muscle. It helps, or holds you steady.



LEVEL TAGS

Beginner

Intermediate

Advanced

The level reflects how much skill, strength or mobility the exercise asks for. It is a guide, not a rule.

LOAD TYPES

Bodyweight

Your own weight is the resistance.

External weight

Barbells, dumbbells, kettlebells and machines.

Banded

Resistance bands add tension through the movement.

READING THE FRAMES

The four frames on page two show one repetition: set up, the lowering or reaching phase, the hardest position, and the finish. Use them with the written steps. If a frame and a step ever seem to disagree, trust your coach and your own body.

SETS AND REPS

The rep ranges come from the Totality exercise library. They are a starting point. Pick the range that matches your goal, choose a weight where the last rep or two feels hard but your technique holds, and adjust from there.

The Squat Pattern

Squats train the quads and glutes together, with the hamstrings, trunk and lower back working to support you. Here are 20 ways to do them, from no equipment to a barbell over your head.



Bodyweight Squat

Beginner



Box Squat

Beginner



Goblet Squat

Beginner



Dumbbell Squat

Beginner



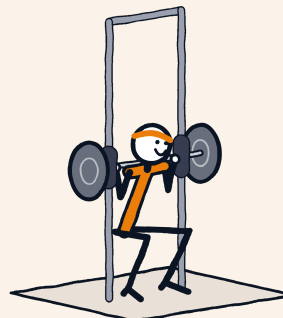
Dumbbell Sumo Squat

Beginner



Barbell Landmine Squat

Beginner



Smith Machine Squat

Beginner

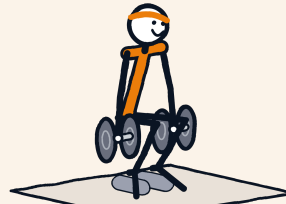
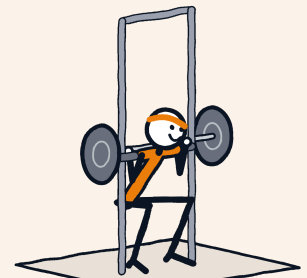


Sumo Squat

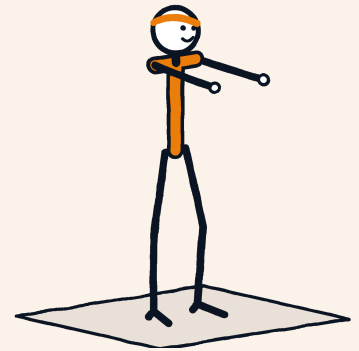
Intermediate

Shown at the bottom of each squat. Exercises run in this order, from simplest to most demanding, and continue on the next page.

The squat pattern, continued

**Wall Sit****Intermediate****Heel-Elevated Goblet Squat****Intermediate****Cyclist Squat****Intermediate****Sissy Squat****Intermediate****Back Squat****Intermediate****Front Squat****Intermediate****Safety Bar Squat****Intermediate****Anderson Squat****Intermediate****Barbell Sumo Squat****Intermediate****Zercher Squat****Intermediate****Overhead Squat****Advanced****Dumbbell Overhead Squat****Advanced**

Squat fundamentals



The squat is one of the basic human movements. You do it every time you sit down and stand up. Every squat in this chapter is built on the same five ideas.

1. STANCE

Feet about shoulder width apart, toes turned out a little. Everyone is built differently, so adjust until the bottom position feels smooth and comfortable.

2. BRACE

Take a breath into your belly and tighten your trunk, as if you were about to be nudged in the stomach. Hold that tension through the rep. If you have a heart condition or high blood pressure, speak to your doctor about breath holding.

3. HIPS AND KNEES TOGETHER

Start the movement by pushing your hips back and bending your knees at the same time. Let your knees follow the line of your toes.

4. BALANCE

Keep your weight over the middle of your foot, with your heels down. If you tip onto your toes or rock back onto your heels, slow down and reset.

5. DEPTH

A good target is thighs about parallel to the floor, or your hip crease at or below knee height. Go only as deep as you can control, with your back position holding steady and your heels down. Depth improves with practice, so let it come over time.

PICK A SQUAT FOR YOUR SITUATION

IF YOU ARE	START WITH
Brand new to squatting	Bodyweight squat, then goblet squat or dumbbell squat
Unsure about depth	Box squat
Training at home	No equipment: bodyweight, sumo, wall sit or sissy squat. With dumbbells: dumbbell, dumbbell sumo or cyclist squat
Learning a loaded squat in a gym	Landmine squat or Smith machine squat
Ready for a barbell	Back squat, front squat, or safety bar squat if your shoulders get sore

Bodyweight Squat

The movement every other squat is built on.

Beginner**No equipment****Bodyweight**

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- **Quadriceps**
- **Glutes**

SECONDARY

- Hamstrings
- Adductors
- Core



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Stand with your feet about shoulder width apart and your toes turned out slightly.
- 2 Take a breath in and brace your trunk, as if you were about to be nudged in the stomach.
- 3 Reach your arms out in front of you. This acts as a counterweight and helps you stay balanced.
- 4 Push your hips back and bend your knees at the same time. Lower until your thighs are about parallel to the floor, or as low as you can go while keeping your heels down.
- 5 Keep your chest tall and let your knees follow the line of your toes.
- 6 Press the floor away and stand all the way up, squeezing your glutes at the top.

COACHING CUES

- Heels stay flat on the floor
- Knees follow the line of your toes
- Chest tall, ribs down
- Control the way down, drive the way up

Common mistake: Knees collapsing inward

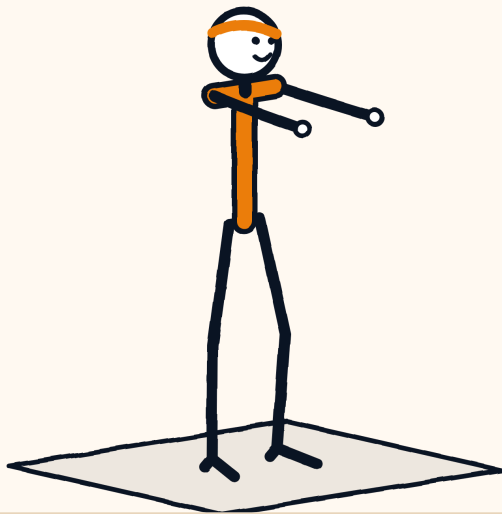
The fix. Spread the floor apart with your feet and push your knees out so they stay in line with your toes. If it keeps happening, slow the rep down and squat to a box until the pattern feels solid.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Anyone learning to squat, anyone warming up for heavier leg work, and anyone training at home or while travelling. It is also useful for building the leg strength needed to stand up from a chair or the floor.

With no load to manage, you can focus on position, depth and balance. That makes it the best place to learn the squat pattern before adding weight. It also works as a warm-up, and as a way to train your legs anywhere.

Bodyweight Squat: the movement



1 Set up

Feet shoulder width, arms forward, trunk braced.



2 Descend

Hips go back and knees bend together.



3 Bottom

Thighs about parallel, heels still down.



4 Drive up

Press the floor away and stand tall.

MAKE IT EASIER

Squat down to a box or chair, or hold on to a stable support with one hand.

MAKE IT HARDER

Slow the lowering phase to three seconds, add a one second pause at the bottom, or move on to the goblet squat.

SETS AND REPS

Learning the pattern

2 to 3 sets of 8 to 12 slow reps

Leg endurance

2 to 4 sets of 15 to 20 reps

Warm-up

1 to 2 sets of 8 to 10 reps

Box Squat

A squat with a target to sit back to.

Beginner

Barbell

Rack

Box

External weight

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

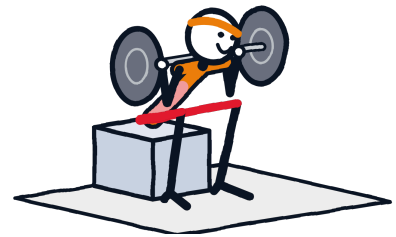
● **Quadriceps**

● **Glutes**

SECONDARY

● Hamstrings

● Core



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Place a sturdy box behind the rack. A good starting height is one where the top of the box sits about level with your knees. A lower box asks for more depth.
- 2 Set the bar on your upper back, unrack it and take a small step back. Stand with your feet shoulder width apart and your toes turned out slightly.
- 3 Brace your trunk, then push your hips back toward the box as your knees bend.
- 4 Lower yourself under control until you touch the box lightly. Keep your chest up and your whole body tight.
- 5 Stay braced on the box for a moment. Do not relax or rock back.
- 6 Drive your feet into the floor and stand up tall.

COACHING CUES

- Hips back first
- Touch the box, do not collapse onto it
- Stay tight while you are on the box
- Chest up as you drive out of the bottom

Common mistake: Dropping onto the box and relaxing

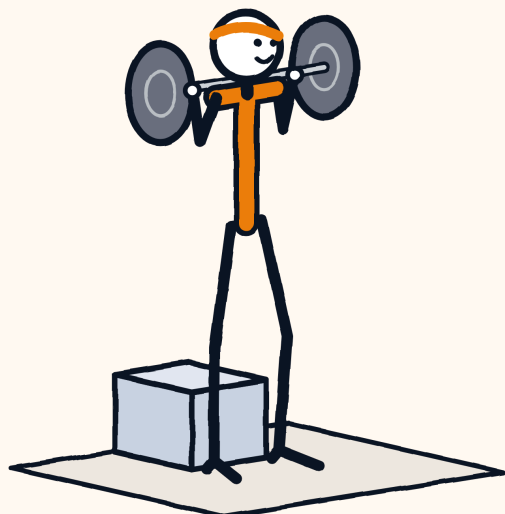
The fix. Lower yourself under control and stay braced the whole time you are touching the box. Think about hovering on it rather than sitting on it, and drive up without rocking back.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

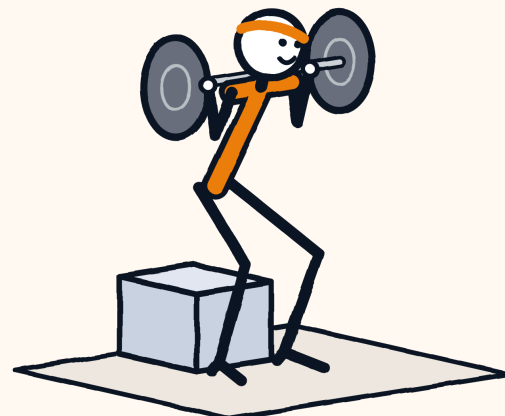
Beginners who find it hard to judge depth, lifters who want to build strength out of the bottom position, and anyone who wants a consistent, repeatable squat depth in their program.

The box gives you a clear depth target every rep, and it teaches you to sit back into a squat. Pausing on the box takes away the rebound out of the bottom, so the strength you build comes from the hardest part of the lift.

Box Squat: the movement



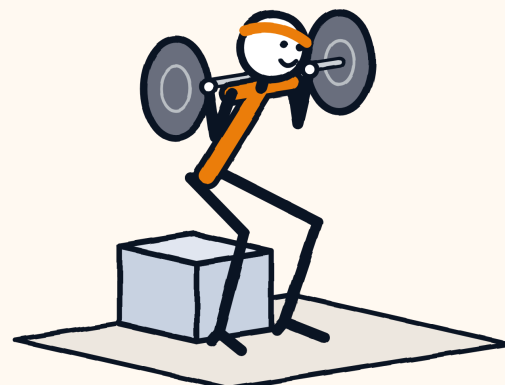
- 1 Set up**
Box behind you, bar on your upper back, braced.



- 2 Descend**
Hips travel back toward the box.



- 3 Bottom**
Touch the box lightly and stay tight.



- 4 Drive up**
Drive through the floor and stand tall.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use a goblet squat or a bodyweight squat to the same box before adding a barbell.

MAKE IT HARDER

Lower the box, hold the pause for longer, add load, or progress to a full back squat.

SETS AND REPS

Strength	3 to 6 reps
Muscle size	6 to 10 reps
Accessory work	8 to 12 reps
Power	5 to 10 fast reps with a light load

Goblet Squat

A squat with a built-in counterweight.

Beginner

Dumbbell or kettlebell

External weight

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- Quadriceps
- Glutes

SECONDARY

- Hamstrings
- Core



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Hold a dumbbell upright by one end, or a kettlebell by its horns, against your chest. Your elbows point down.
- 2 Stand with your feet about shoulder width apart and your toes turned out slightly.
- 3 Take a breath in and brace your trunk.
- 4 Sit down between your hips, keeping your chest tall and the weight close to you.
- 5 At the bottom, your elbows should slide inside your knees. Keep your heels down.
- 6 Press through your whole foot to stand up.

COACHING CUES

- Hold the weight at your chest, elbows pointing down
- Sit down between your hips
- Knees follow the line of your toes
- Drive through your heels to stand

Common mistake: Folding forward as the weight drops

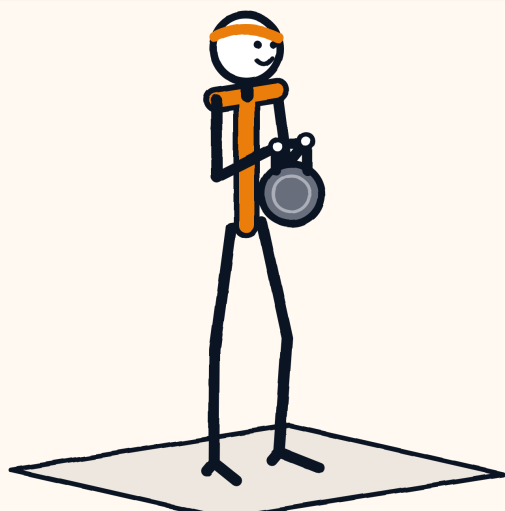
The fix. Keep the weight tight against your chest, keep your elbows down and brace before every rep. If you still fold forward, use a lighter weight or squat to a box.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Beginners, people training at home with a single dumbbell or kettlebell, anyone who struggles to keep their chest up in a squat, and lifters who want a quick warm-up before heavier squats.

The weight held in front of you works as a counterbalance, so most people find it easier to stay upright and squat deeper than they can with no load. It builds leg strength with very little equipment, and it is one of the best ways to teach squat mechanics.

Goblet Squat: the movement



1 Set up

Weight at your chest, elbows down, braced.



2 Descend

Sit down between your hips.



3 Bottom

Elbows inside the knees, heels down.



4 Drive up

Drive through your heels and stand tall.

MAKE IT EASIER

Do a bodyweight squat, or goblet squat to a box.

MAKE IT HARDER

Use a heavier weight, lower slowly for three seconds, pause at the bottom, or progress to the front squat.

SETS AND REPS

Beginners

3 sets of 10 to 15 reps

Muscle size

3 to 4 sets of 12 to 20 reps

Warm-up

2 sets of 15 to 20 light reps

Dumbbell Squat

A squat with a dumbbell hanging at each side.

Beginner**Dumbbells****External weight**

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- **Quadriceps**
- **Glutes**

SECONDARY

- Hamstrings
- Core



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Pick up a dumbbell in each hand and let your arms hang at your sides. Stand with your feet about shoulder width apart and your toes turned out a little.
- 2 Take a breath in and brace your trunk. Keep your chest tall and your eyes forward.
- 3 Push your hips back and bend your knees together. The dumbbells travel down beside your legs.
- 4 Lower until your thighs are about parallel to the floor, or as low as you can go while keeping your heels down and your chest tall.
- 5 Press through your whole foot and stand all the way up, squeezing your glutes at the top.

COACHING CUES

- Keep your chest tall all the way down
- Sit your hips back and down
- Drive evenly through your whole foot
- Keep the dumbbells close to your legs
- Heels stay on the floor

Common mistake: Your chest drops and your shoulders round forward as the weights pull you down

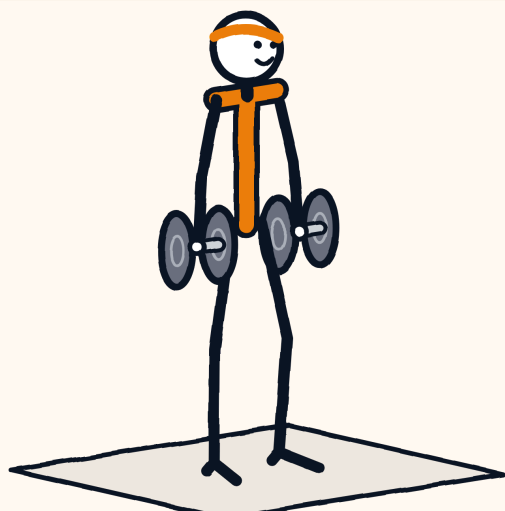
The fix. Brace your trunk, keep your shoulders back and your eyes forward, and squeeze the handles. Use lighter dumbbells until your chest stays tall on every rep.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Beginners who are ready to add weight, people who train at home with a pair of dumbbells, and anyone who wants leg work without a rack or a bar on their back.

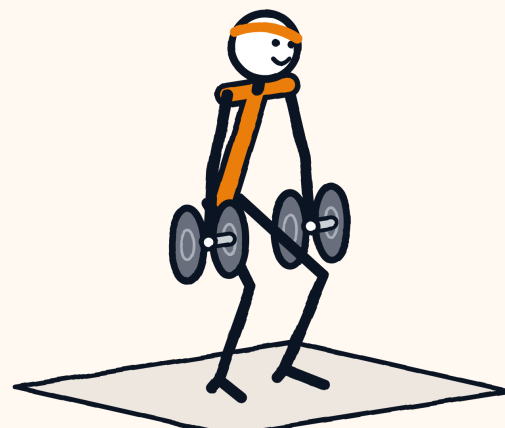
Dumbbells at your sides need less setup and less bracing than a barbell on your back, so you can load your legs and still focus on a clean movement. It is a simple way to move on from the bodyweight squat, and it suits high-rep work.

Dumbbell Squat: the movement



1 Set up

Stand tall with a dumbbell at each side.



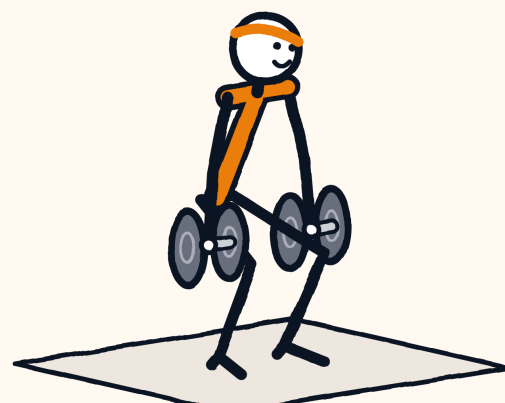
2 Descend

Hips go back, knees bend, dumbbells slide down by your legs.



3 Bottom

Thighs about parallel, chest still tall.



4 Drive up

Press the floor away and stand tall.

MAKE IT EASIER

Squat with your body weight, or hold one lighter dumbbell against your chest in the goblet squat.

MAKE IT HARDER

Use heavier dumbbells, slow the lowering to three seconds, pause for a second at the bottom, or move on to the barbell squats.

SETS AND REPS

Muscle size	10 to 15 reps
Learning the movement	8 to 12 slow reps
How many sets	2 to 4

Dumbbell Sumo Squat

A wide stance squat holding one dumbbell upright between your legs.

Beginner**Dumbbell****External weight**

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- **Quadriceps**
- **Glutes**

SECONDARY

- Adductors
- Core



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Stand with your feet wider than shoulder width and your toes turned out. Hold one dumbbell upright by its top end with both hands, in front of your hips.
- 2 Brace your trunk and keep your chest up.
- 3 Bend your knees and push them out in line with your toes, sitting straight down between your feet.
- 4 Lower until your thighs are about parallel to the floor, or as low as you can go with your chest tall and your heels down.
- 5 Push the floor away and stand up, squeezing your glutes and inner thighs at the top.

COACHING CUES

- Keep your chest up the whole way
- Push your knees out in line with your toes
- Sit straight down rather than back
- Keep the dumbbell close to your body
- Drive evenly through both feet

Common mistake: Knees drifting inward as you stand up

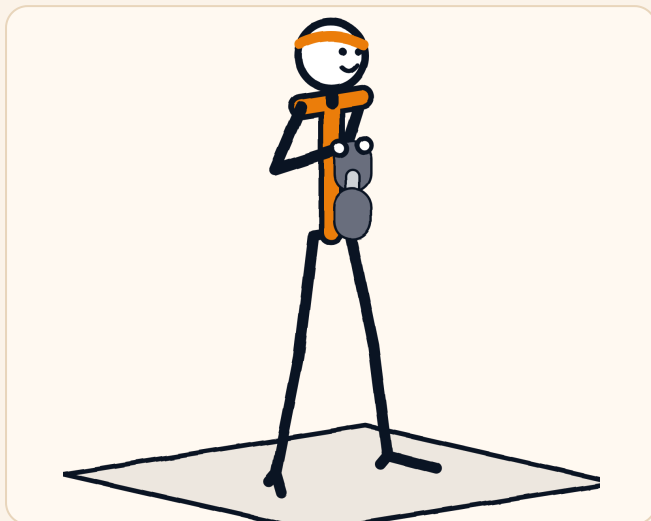
The fix. Think about spreading the floor apart with your feet and pushing your knees out over your toes. If it keeps happening, narrow your stance a little or lower the weight.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Beginners who want to add weight to a wide stance squat, and anyone who wants more inner thigh and glute work from a squat.

The wide stance and turned-out feet shift more of the work to your inner thighs and glutes than a standard squat stance does. Holding the weight in front of you also helps you stay upright.

Dumbbell Sumo Squat: the movement



- 1 Set up**
Wide stance, toes out, dumbbell held upright.



- 2 Descend**
Knees push out and you sit straight down.



- 3 Bottom**
Thighs about parallel, chest tall.



- 4 Drive up**
Drive up and squeeze glutes and inner thighs.

MAKE IT EASIER

Do the bodyweight sumo squat with your hands together in front of your chest.

MAKE IT HARDER

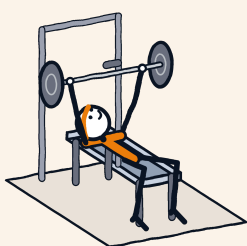
Use a heavier dumbbell, slow the lowering to three seconds, pause at the bottom, or move on to the barbell sumo squat.

SETS AND REPS

Muscle size	10 to 15 reps
Learning the movement	8 to 12 slow reps
How many sets	2 to 4

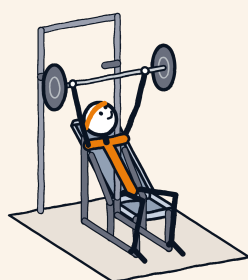
Chest Presses

Pressing is the main way to build the chest, the front of the shoulders and the back of the arms. This chapter covers ten presses, from a guided machine for beginners, through dumbbells, to the barbell bench press and its variations.



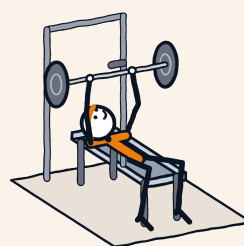
Barbell Bench Press

Intermediate



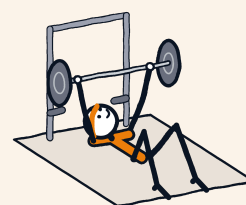
Incline Bench Press

Intermediate



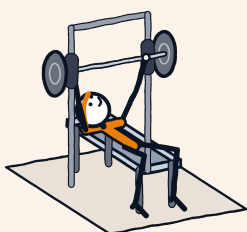
Close-Grip Bench Press

Intermediate



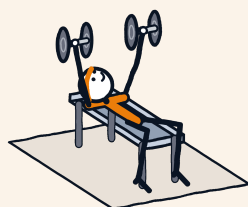
Floor Press

Beginner



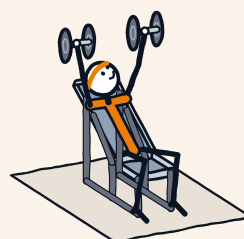
Smith Machine Bench Press

Intermediate



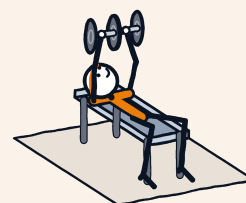
Dumbbell Bench Press

Beginner



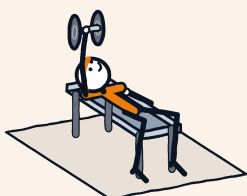
Dumbbell Incline Press

Beginner



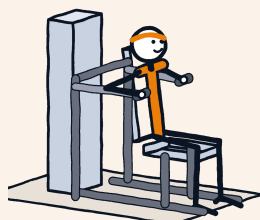
Hex Press

Intermediate



Single-Arm Dumbbell Press

Intermediate



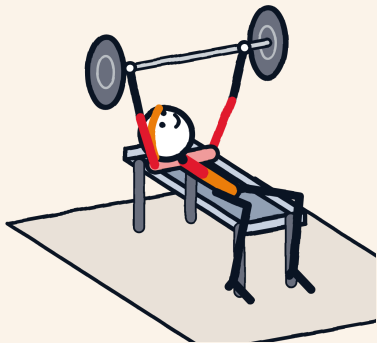
Chest Press Machine

Beginner

Shown at the start position of each exercise.

Pressing fundamentals

A press moves a weight away from your chest while your back stays braced against something solid. Whether the weight is a bar, a pair of dumbbells or a machine handle, the same five ideas keep the work in your chest and out of your shoulder joints.



1. SET YOUR SHOULDERS FIRST

Before you unrack or lift the weights, squeeze your shoulder blades together and down into the bench or pad. Keep them there for the whole set. This gives your chest a firm base.

2. STACK WRISTS OVER ELBOWS

At the bottom of each rep your forearms should be roughly upright, with your wrists straight and directly above your elbows. If your wrists bend back or your forearms lean far out, the weight is on the wrong path.

3. PLANT YOUR FEET

Keep your feet flat on the floor and push through them as you press. Your head, upper back and hips stay on the bench for every rep, so the effort goes into the weight and not into arching or lifting.

4. CONTROL THE LOWERING

Take about two seconds to lower the weight, with your elbows at roughly 45 to 75 degrees from your body, and not flared straight out to the sides. Then press up with intent. A controlled rep builds more than a dropped one.

5. SET UP FOR SAFETY

Use a rack with the safety arms set just below your chest, or a spotter, whenever you train close to failure with a bar. Put collars on the bar. With dumbbells, bring them up from your thighs and lower them back to your thighs when you finish, instead of dropping them. If a press causes sharp pain in your shoulder or elbow, stop and get it checked.

BAR, DUMBBELLS OR MACHINE?

	BARBELL	DUMBBELLS	MACHINES
Examples	Bench press, incline, close-grip, floor press	Dumbbell bench, incline, hex press, single-arm	Chest press machine, Smith machine bench
Range of motion	Stops when the bar touches your chest	You can lower further for a bigger stretch	Set by the machine
Best for	Heavy loads in small steps	Even sides and a deeper stretch	Learning the pattern, safe high-effort sets

Barbell Bench Press

Lie on a bench, lower the bar to your chest and press it back up.

Intermediate

Barbell

Flat bench

Rack

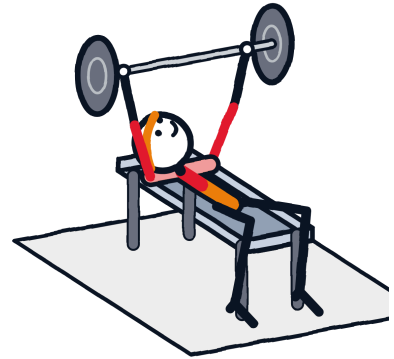
MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- Chest
- Triceps

SECONDARY

- Front deltoids
- Upper back



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Lie on the bench with your eyes under the bar, your feet flat on the floor and your head, upper back and hips on the pad.
- 2 Squeeze your shoulder blades together and down into the bench, and grip the bar slightly wider than shoulder width with your thumbs wrapped around it.
- 3 Unrack the bar and hold it straight over your shoulders with your arms extended.
- 4 Lower the bar under control to your lower chest, with your elbows about 45 to 75 degrees away from your body.
- 5 Touch the bar lightly to your chest, without bouncing it.
- 6 Drive your feet into the floor and press the bar back up to full lockout. Rerack it when your set is done.

COACHING CUES

- Squeeze your shoulder blades together and down
- Grip slightly wider than shoulder width
- Lower to your lower chest, elbows at about 45 to 75 degrees
- Drive your feet into the floor and lock out at the top

Common mistake: Bouncing the bar off your chest or lifting your hips off the bench

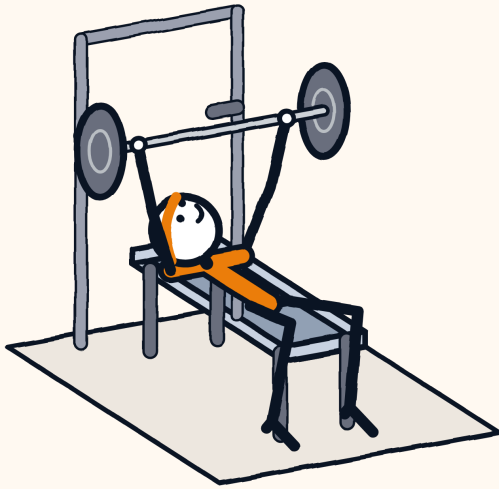
The fix. Lower the bar under control, touch it lightly to your chest, and keep your head, upper back and hips on the bench for the whole rep. If your hips lift, the weight is too heavy for now.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Anyone building pressing strength or chest size, once you are comfortable with the dumbbell bench press. Train in a rack with safety arms, or with a spotter, whenever you work close to failure.

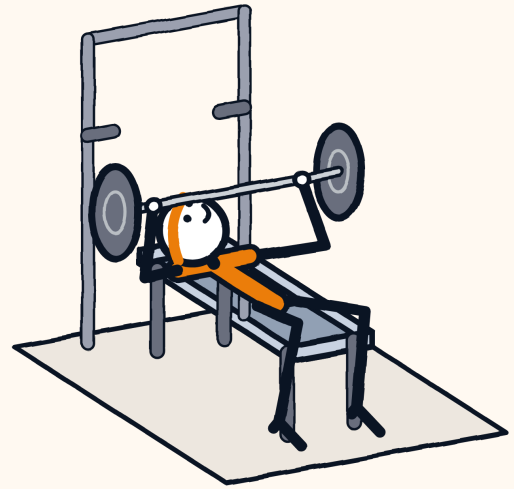
The barbell bench press lets you load your chest, triceps and front shoulders heavier than almost any other upper body exercise. The stable position means you can add weight in small steps over time, which makes progress easy to track.

Barbell Bench Press: the movement



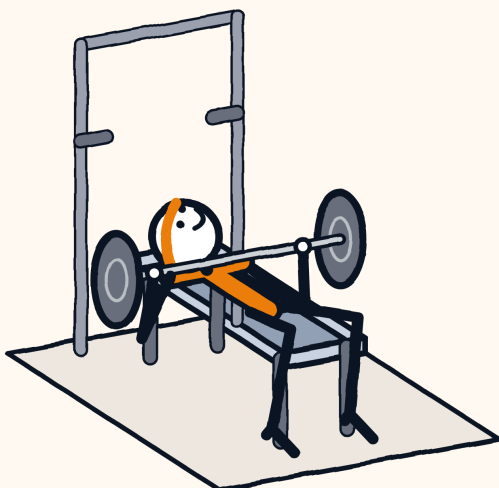
1 Unrack

Arms straight, the bar over your shoulders.



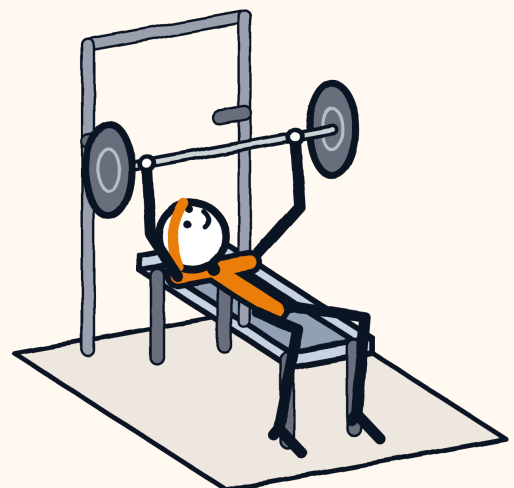
2 Lower

The bar comes down as your elbows bend.



3 Touch

The bar touches your lower chest, forearms upright.



4 Press

Press up and slightly back, driving through your feet.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use the dumbbell bench press or the chest press machine, or lighten the bar and use a spotter.

MAKE IT HARDER

Add weight in small steps, pause the bar on your chest for a second, or move to the incline or close-grip bench press.

SETS AND REPS

Strength

1 to 5 reps, heavy

Muscle growth

6 to 12 reps

Volume work

3 to 4 sets of 10 to 15 reps

Rest

2 to 3 minutes between heavy sets

Incline Bench Press

A bench press on an incline that shifts the work to your upper chest.

Intermediate

Barbell

Incline bench

Rack

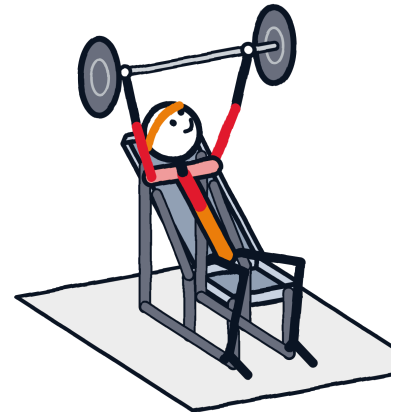
MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- Upper chest
- Triceps

SECONDARY

- Front deltoids
- Middle chest



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Set the bench to an incline of 30 to 45 degrees and lie back with your feet flat on the floor.
- 2 Squeeze your shoulder blades together and down into the pad, and grip the bar slightly wider than shoulder width.
- 3 Unrack the bar and hold it over your shoulders with your arms extended.
- 4 Lower the bar under control to your upper chest, near your collarbone, with your elbows at about 60 degrees from your body.
- 5 Touch the bar lightly to your chest, without bouncing it.
- 6 Press the bar up and slightly back to full lockout, then rerack it when your set is done.

COACHING CUES

- Set the bench to 30 to 45 degrees, not steeper
- Lower the bar to your upper chest
- Keep your elbows at roughly 60 degrees
- Press the bar up and slightly back

Common mistake: Setting the bench too steep

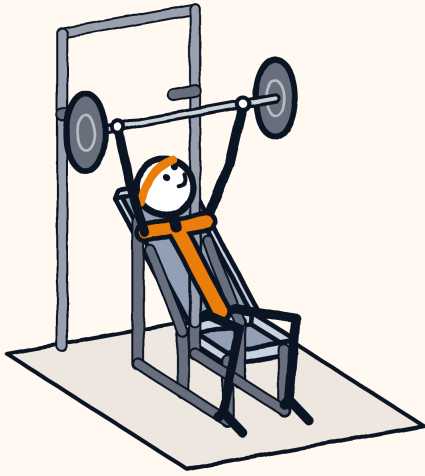
The fix. Keep the bench between 30 and 45 degrees. Past that angle the lift turns into a shoulder press and your chest does less of the work.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

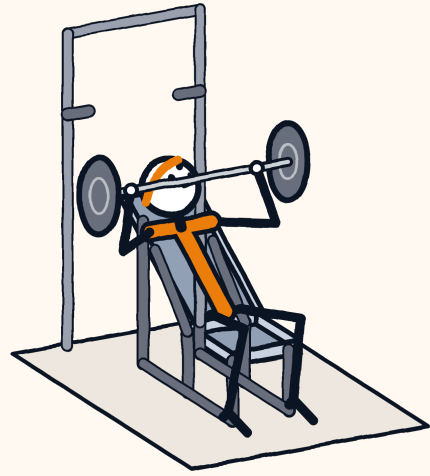
Lifters who already bench press and want to bring up the upper chest. If your shoulders feel pinched on the flat bench, a lower incline can also feel more comfortable.

Pressing on an incline puts more of the load on the upper part of your chest and on your front shoulders. It works well alongside the flat bench press, as a second pressing exercise for a fuller looking chest.

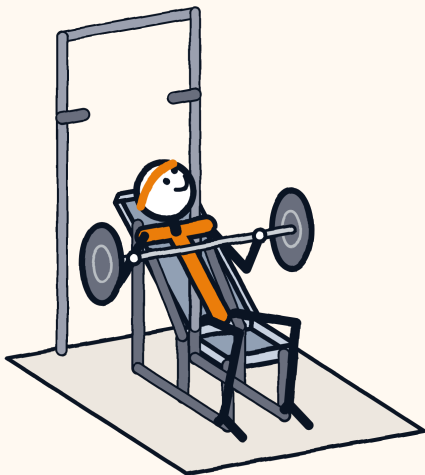
Incline Bench Press: the movement

**1 Unrack**

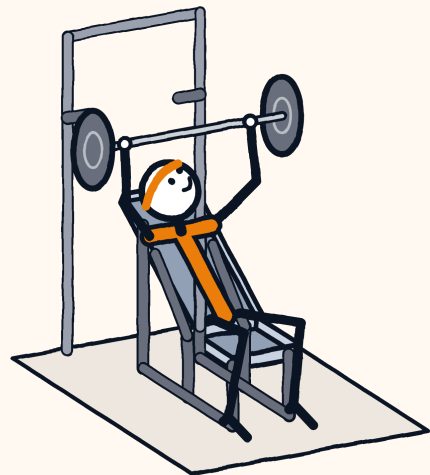
Arms straight, the bar over your shoulders.

**2 Lower**

The bar comes down toward your upper chest.

**3 Touch**

The bar touches your upper chest, forearms upright.

**4 Press**

Press up and slightly back to lockout.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use the dumbbell incline press with lighter weights, which lets each arm find its own path.

MAKE IT HARDER

Add weight in small steps, pause the bar on your upper chest, or slow the lowering down to three seconds.

SETS AND REPS**Strength**

4 to 8 reps

Muscle growth

8 to 15 reps

Volume work

3 to 4 sets of 10 to 12 reps

Rest

2 to 3 minutes between heavy sets

Close-Grip Bench Press

Bench press with your hands closer together to bring in the triceps.

Intermediate

Barbell

Flat bench

Rack

MUSCLES WORKED

PRIMARY

- Triceps
- Chest

SECONDARY

- Front deltoids



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Lie on the bench as you would for a bench press, with your feet flat and your shoulder blades squeezed together.
- 2 Grip the bar with your hands about shoulder width apart, or a little narrower. Do not go closer than that.
- 3 Unrack the bar and hold it over your lower chest with your arms extended.
- 4 Lower the bar under control to your lower chest, keeping your elbows tucked close to your body.
- 5 Touch your chest lightly, without bouncing.
- 6 Press the bar back up to full lockout, keeping your elbows in, then rerack it when your set is done.

COACHING CUES

- Hands about shoulder width apart, no closer
- Keep your elbows tucked
- Control the lowering, then press hard
- Lock out fully at the top

Common mistake: Gripping the bar too narrowly

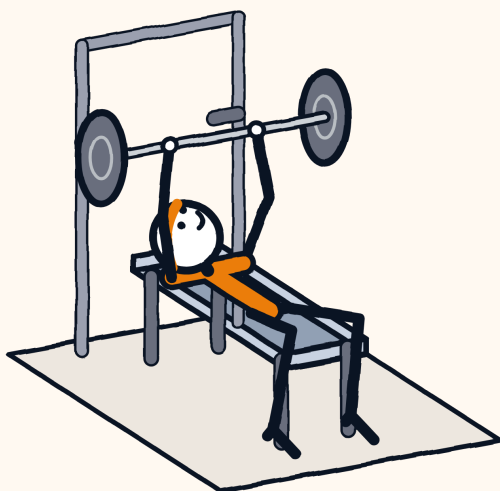
The fix. Place your hands about shoulder width apart. A very close grip strains your wrists and elbows and does not work your triceps any better.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

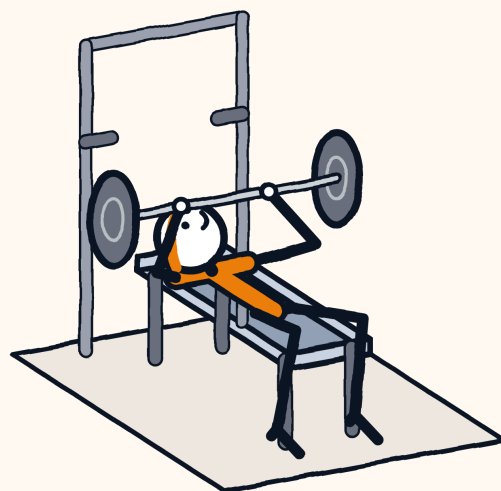
Lifters who want bigger triceps or a stronger finish to their bench press. Use a rack, and a spotter for heavy sets.

Bringing your hands in shifts more of the work onto your triceps, while your chest and front shoulders still help. It is a good way to build the lockout strength that carries over to your regular bench press.

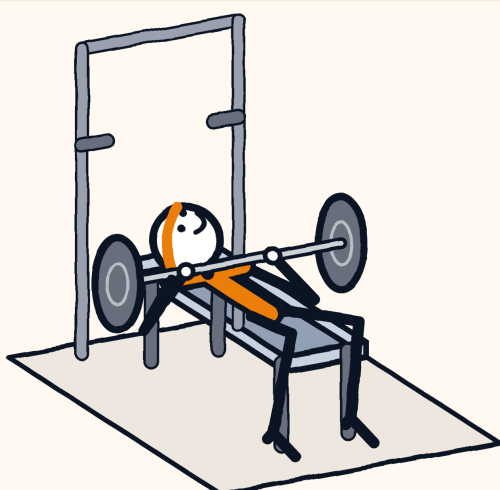
Close-Grip Bench Press: the movement



- 1 Unrack**
Hands close, the bar over your lower chest.



- 2 Lower**
Lower with your elbows tucked.



- 3 Touch**
Touch your lower chest, elbows close to your body.



- 4 Press**
Press up and lock out your arms.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use a lighter bar, or try the floor press, which limits how deep you go.

MAKE IT HARDER

Add weight in small steps, pause on your chest, or slow the lowering down.

SETS AND REPS

Strength	5 to 8 reps
Muscle growth	6 to 10 reps
Accessory work	8 to 12 reps
Volume work	10 to 15 reps

Floor Press

Press from the floor so your elbows stop when they touch it.

Beginner

Barbell

Rack

Floor

MUSCLES WORKED

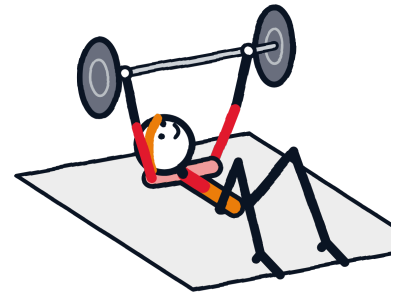
PRIMARY

● Triceps

● Chest

SECONDARY

● Front deltoids



HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Set the bar low in a rack, then lie on your back on the floor with your knees bent and your feet flat.
- 2 Grip the bar slightly wider than shoulder width and press it off the hooks, so it sits over your chest with your arms extended.
- 3 Lower the bar under control until the backs of your upper arms touch the floor.
- 4 Pause for a second with your arms resting on the floor, without relaxing your shoulders.
- 5 Press the bar back up to full lockout.
- 6 Rerack the bar when your set is done.

COACHING CUES

- Lie flat with your back and head on the floor
- Lower until your upper arms touch the floor
- Pause, then press
- Lock out your arms at the top

Common mistake: Bouncing your elbows off the floor

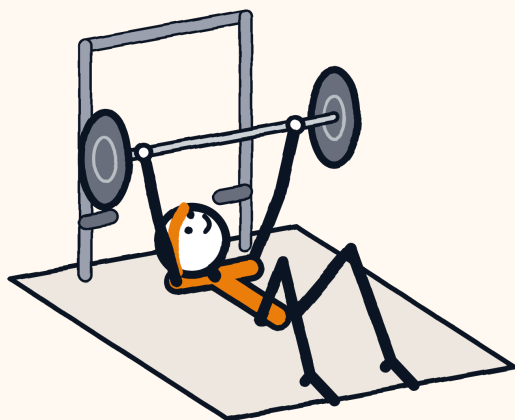
The fix. Lower until your upper arms lightly touch the floor, pause for a second, and then press. A bounce takes the work off your muscles and can jar your elbows.

WHO IT SUITS AND WHY IT WORKS

Lifters whose shoulders dislike a deep bench press, beginners learning to press with a barbell, and anyone working on a stronger lockout. Set the rack up first so you can unrack and rerack safely.

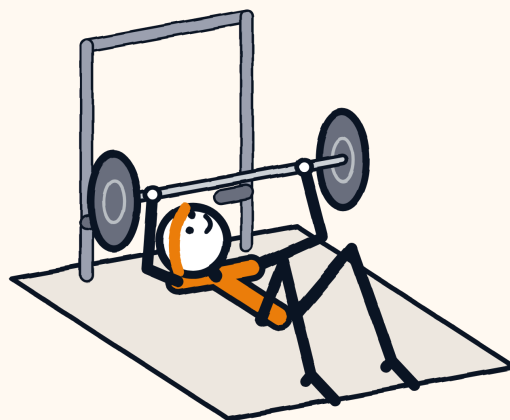
The floor stops your elbows, which limits how far you lower the bar and can feel kinder on the shoulders. With your legs flat or bent and no bench, there is little leg drive, so your triceps and chest do the work.

Floor Press: the movement



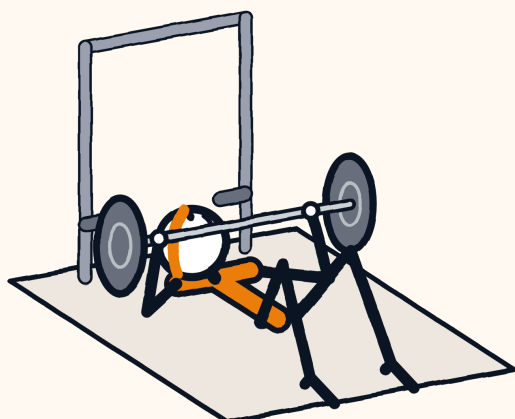
1 Unrack

Lie on the floor, the bar over your chest.



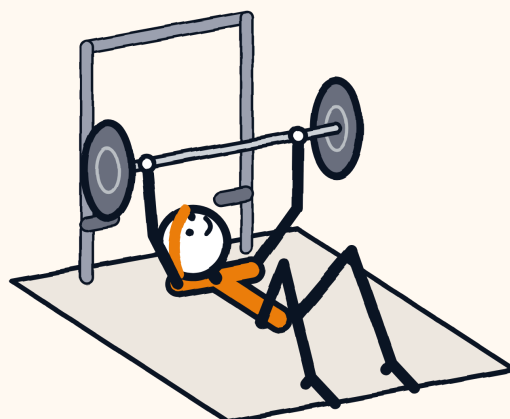
2 Lower

Lower the bar as your elbows bend.



3 Elbows touch

Your upper arms touch the floor.



4 Press

Press up and lock out.

MAKE IT EASIER

Use lighter weight, or press a pair of dumbbells from the floor.

MAKE IT HARDER

Add weight in small steps, pause for longer on the floor, or move on to the bench press.

SETS AND REPS

Muscle growth	8 to 12 reps
Accessory work	10 to 15 reps
Volume work	12 to 20 reps
How many sets	3 to 4

THAT WAS THE PREVIEW

There are 371 exercises in the full guide.

You have seen how every exercise is laid out: the muscles worked, the steps, the cues, the common mistake, and the movement drawn in four frames.

WHAT YOU GET

- 34 chapters across legs, upper body, core and full body
- 371 exercises, each drawn step by step in four frames
- Three PDF volumes plus an A to Z index
- One payment of A\$39.99, instant download

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